Title Page

Project 1
iOS Clock App Redesign

Group member names + tasks

- **Anthoney Xie**
  - Root Goal Analysis / Summary
- **Jaden Boggs**
  - Protocol / Summary
- **Scott MacLaren**
  - Persona / Summary
- **Om Chinchwadkar**
  - Protocol / Summary
- **Sangavi**
  - Proposal / Summary
- **Varsha**
  - Proposal / Summary

Summary

Summary

iOS Clock App Redesign

Users

The anticipated user population includes people who rely on the iOS Clock app for daily time management, such as students, professionals, and parents. These users often set multiple alarms for waking up, reminders, and scheduling, as well as timers for tasks like cooking, workouts, or productivity tracking.

The average user we will focus on is a college student who uses this app to manage their daily routine. Besides for waking up, they usually set multiple alarms for class and work reminders, appointments and plans they've made, and general responsibilities. They also use the timer for everyday tasks, studying methods, or workouts. However, they may find the app's interface cluttered and inflexible, with limited customization options for alarms and timers. Their primary goal is to efficiently manage their time, but the app's current design limits their ability to organize and personalize their alarms and timers effectively.

Research Activity

We plan on conducting user interviews and usability tests with classmates who use the iOS Clock app. We will explore their challenges with the app's current features, such as the snooze duration, alarm organization, and timer limitations. Additionally, we will gather feedback on potential improvements, such as customizable snooze durations, alarm categorization, and adjust timers.

Research Goals

This study will help us understand how college students interact with the Clock app and identify their goals when using it, along with challenges that make it difficult to manage their time. Learning more about their needs and preferences can help us design a more intuitive and customizable interface that better aligns with their goals. This research will inform our redesign by highlighting features that users value most and revealing opportunities that can improve usability and functionality.

Persona

User Persona

Alex Smith

Age: 20
Income: ~$11,000/year
Location: Austin, TX

Background

Alex is a junior at the University of Texas, Austin, majoring in Computer Science. He lives in an off-campus apartment with two roommates. As a high-strung individual, his daily schedule is stuffed with classes, coding projects, and a part-time job as a TA. He first started using the iOS Clock app in high school just for waking up on time, but now relies on it for much more: setting reminders for deadlines, using timers for study sessions, workouts, and cooking, as well as using the World Clock to remind himself when to call his parents in Sweden.

Experience/Usage

- Uses the Clock app multiple times a day.
- Sets at least five alarms daily: one to wake up, others for classes, work shifts, and task reminders.

User Persona

- Uses the timer feature frequently for Pomodoro study sessions and workouts.
- Finds the interface cluttered, making it difficult to manage multiple alarms. ● Wishes alarms could be categorized and personalized by day (his schedule is varied)
- Annoyed by the fixed snooze duration.

Hobbies & Interests

- Passionate about developing small apps.
- Enjoys working out at the campus gym.
- Loves teaching kids how to learn in weed-out classes.
- Unwinds with a good book or a podcast.

Goals

- Stay organized and on top of his schedule.
- Improve focus and time management.
- Customize his alarms and timers to fit his lifestyle.

Tasks

- Quickly set and manage alarms for different parts of his day.
- Use timers effectively for studying, workouts, and cooking.
- Avoid oversleeping by having better control over snooze settings.

Relevant Relationships

- Shares a small apartment with two roommates who have different sleep schedules, making smart alarm management crucial.
- Studies in groups where synchronized timers could be helpful for productivity.
- Works with irregular shifts, requiring flexible scheduling.

Expectations

- Wants an intuitive interface that makes organizing alarms and timers easier.
- Expects customizable snooze durations.
- Expects alarms to be easily categorized for different activities.
- Expects multiple timers with labels for better tracking.

Quotes

User Persona

"*I have so many alarms set, and it's a nightmare trying to find the right one when I need to adjust it.*"

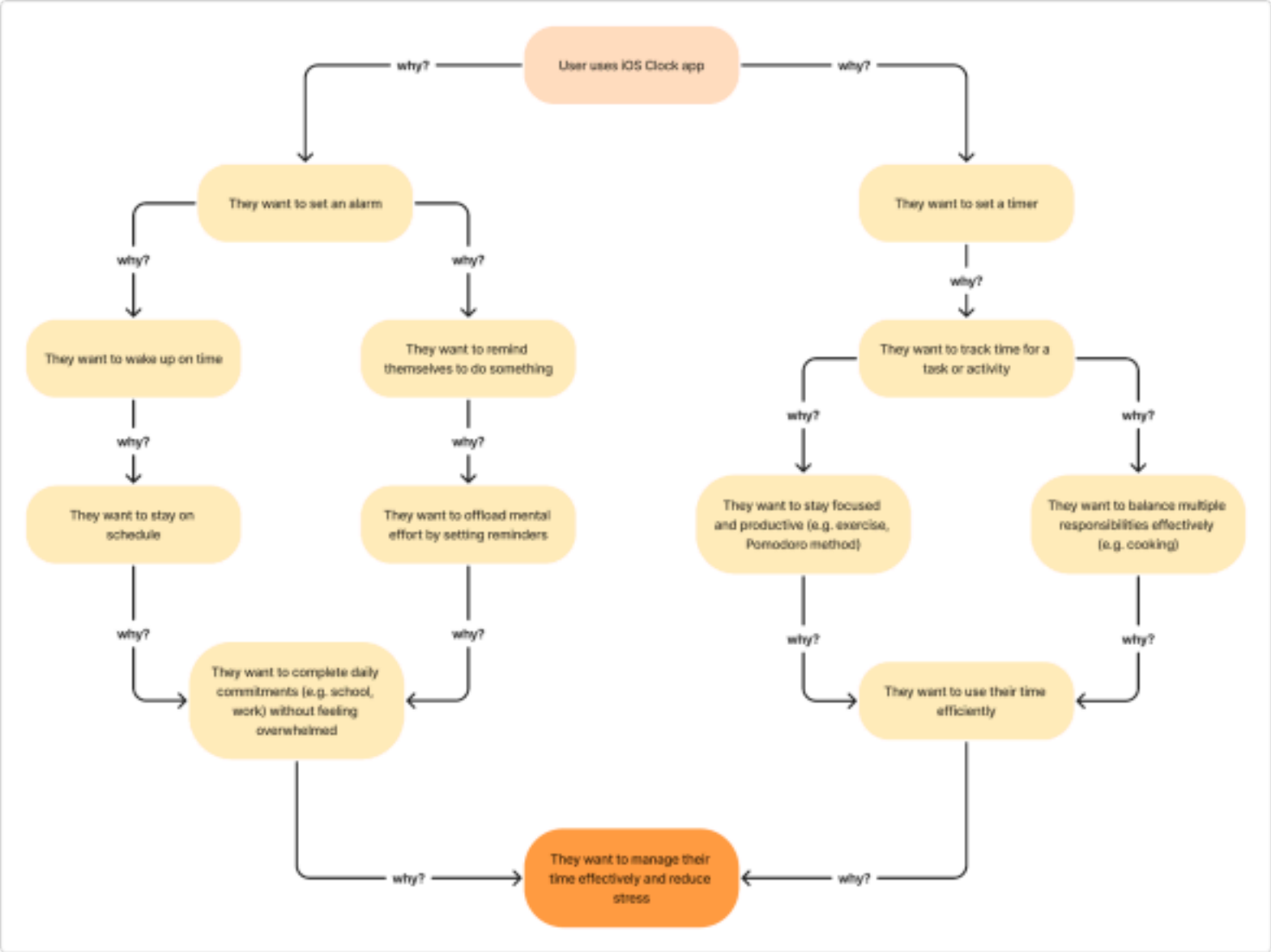
"*It'd be great if I could set and label multiple timers—one for teaching timing, one for studying, one for workouts.*"

"*Snooze is stuck at 9 mins. I want to set it how I like.*"

Root Cause Analysis

Ultimate Goal Root Cause

ultimate goal



Proposal

Discovery Research Activity Proposal

History

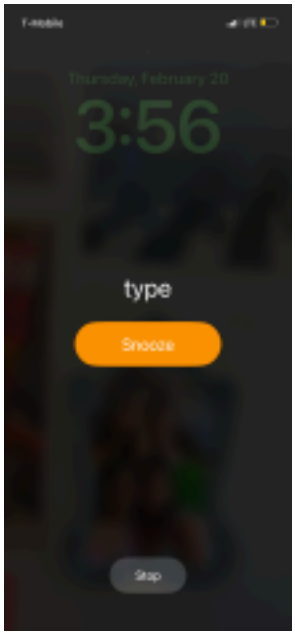
The iOS clock app feature has been part of the initial Apple iPhone launch in 2007. It is a core feature that comes with every iOS device, however we will mainly focus on the functionality of the application within the context of the iPhone. There have been minor updates since its initial launch in 2007, such as making the widget's hand and hour screen bolder, being able to customize the clock on the lockscreen, and simultaneous timers. Overall, the feature has been fairly untouched. The capabilities of the clock feature are as follows: word clock, alarms, stopwatch, and timers.

As our dependency on technology increases, there are novel necessities the average iPhone user has. For example, according to online forums such as Reddit, many individuals need multiple timers for a variety of reasons, including waking up, classes, appointments, household chores, and studying. The current interface has limited functionality, hindering users from utilizing the application for enhanced productivity.

Additionally, there is a lack of customization with the app; for example, there is no way to organize different timers or alarms based on a specific category such as "studying" or "workout". Furthermore, it is not intuitive at all to add time to an existing timer, which is another common, simple functionality that users desire. The biggest pain point for users is not being able to adjust their snooze time. Apple automatically snoozes for 9 minutes, however users generally want to customize the amount of time they wish to snooze for.

There are also other complaints such as not being able to turn off all alarms at once, adjusting the overall volume of the phone instead of just the alarms, or being unable to add time to a timer.

Discovery Research Activity Proposal



By redesigning the application, not only will these pain points be addressed, but also there will be a wider functionality for users to customize their alarms and categorize their timers. Although iPhone users use the clock feature, some people have started to move off to different platforms. This could eventually lead to a larger negative sentiment towards the clock feature, and it is vital that Apple redesigns the system as soon as possible.

Since there is such a wide variety of use cases, the scope of our project is not yet fully understood. Overall, we aim to improve the user experience by redesigning the application so that it is customizable and intuitive with increased functionality.

Objectives, Measures, and Scope

This study focuses on analyzing user behaviors, preferences, and frustrations when using the iOS Clock app, particularly its alarm and timer functionalities. By conducting qualitative research through user interviews and usability tests, we aim to understand how users interact with the app and identify design improvements to enhance usability and efficiency.

The key objectives of this study are:

- To identify the fundamental needs of users when managing alarms, timers, and other Clock app features.

Discovery Research Activity Proposal

- To examine user routines and behaviors related to the Clock app in their daily lives.
- To uncover common usability issues and pain points within the current Clock app design.
- To propose potential solutions that improve the app's functionality, customization, and overall user experience.

Research Questions

- In what situations do users rely on the Clock app?
- How do users interact with the alarm and timer application on a daily basis?
- What are the primary frustrations users experience with the app? ● How can the clock app help users utilize their time more effectively?

Data Collection

The following information will be gathered from participants:

- Overall opinions and experience interacting with the iOS Clock app
- Usage habits and routines (e.g., frequency, devices used)
- Common difficulties experienced with alarms, timers, and other Clock features

Method, Participants, Recruitment, and Incentives

The main method we will be using is gathering qualitative research through conducting user interviews and usability tests.

Procedure

6 interviews will be conducted between February 21, 2025 and March 7, 2025 ● Each interview will be casual but semi-structured, with a set of key questions covering general user habits, experiences with specific features, and any frustrations they've encountered.

- Participants will be encouraged to go into detail about their answers, and if needed, they may walk the interviewer through how they use the app in real time.

Participants

All participants must meet the following criteria:

- Be a current UCLA student enrolled in the PSYCH 124B: Fundamentals of User Research course

Discovery Research Activity Proposal

- Use or be familiar with the iOS Clock app (alarms, timers, stopwatch, etc.)

Recruitment

Participants will be recruited through a spreadsheet on the PSYCH 124B Bruinlearn website, where interested students can sign up. A total of six students will be selected for interviews, which will be conducted by members of the research team.

Compensation

To thank participants for their time, they will receive discussion credits for PSYCH 124B, which count toward their final grade.

Responsibilities and Proposed Schedule

Each team member will be responsible for different aspects of the research process, from conducting interviews to analyzing data and developing recommendations for the iOS Clock app redesign. The schedule below outlines key tasks and their expected timelines.

Name	Responsibility	Estimated Duration
Srivarsha	Conducting interviews, data analysis, assisting with prototype design	2 weeks
Jaden	Conducting interviews, summarizing findings, drafting report sections	2 weeks
Scott	Developing the initial prototype based on research insights	2 weeks
Anthoney	Defining initial requirements for redesign, assisting with report writing	2 weeks

Om Assisting with prototype development, providing feedback on design iterations 2 weeks

Sangavi Defining initial requirements, organizing research materials 2 weeks

Discovery Research Activity Proposal

Proposed Timeline

- **Week 7 (Feb 17 - Feb 21, 2025)**: Finalize research questions & methods, Finalize interview questions
- **Week 8 (Feb 21 - Mar 7, 2025)**: Recruit participants, Conduct five user interviews, document responses
- **Week 9 (Mar 7 - Mar 14, 2025)**: Analyze interview data, identify key takeaways
- **Week 10 (Mar 14 - Mar 21, 2025)**: Develop initial redesign recommendations and prototype
- **Finals Week (Mar 21 - Mar 28, 2025)**: Finalize report and submit findings

Protocol

Discovery Research Activity Protocol

Before Participant Arrives:

- If in-person
    - Reserve study room for in person interviews
    - Give participant location of study room
    - Prepare equipment for note taking
    - Have questions ready and all other materials
- If over Zoom
    - Make sure correct link is used
    - Set up meeting 5-10 minutes beforehand
    - Check that audio and video are working
    - Prepare note-taking materials

After Participant Arrives:

- Greet participant and introduce interviewer.
- Inform the participant that the interviewer will be taking notes.
- Ask if it is okay to record the interview.
- Begin interview according to the script

Introduction Script:

Hello, [Participant Name], my name is [Interviewer Name] and I will be your interviewer today. Thank you for signing up to participate in our research project. The main purpose of our study is to understand iOS clock users' experiences using the app and any concerns or opinions they may have regarding the app.

Also, there are no right or wrong answers for the following questions. As researchers we simply want to gauge your experience with the product. So feel free to answer these questions truthfully.

Lastly, feel free to refer to the iOS clock app if you feel like it'll help you answer the questions.

<u>Ice Breakers:</u>

1. Do you have a favorite alarm sound?
2. When was the last time you or your roommates were woken up by each other's blaring alarms?

3. Have you ever been in a situation where you needed to wake up at a certain time in the morning but your phone died in the middle of the night so you overslept?

Intro Questions:

1. When did you start using the iOS Clock App?
2. Why did you start using the clock app?
3. How often do you use the clock app?

Key Questions:

BROAD:

1. When do you most frequently use the clock app (i.e in what circumstances/situations)?
2. What do you like about the clock app?
3. What do you dislike about the clock app?
4. Have you tried any alternatives to the clock app and if so what did you like/dislike about them?
5. Did you continue using the alternative app or switch back to the clock app and why?
6. If you want to set a reminder for later out of all the apps or methods you have, what is your go to method?

SPECIFIC:

"We will now talk a little bit about the features of the iOS Clock App."

1. What features of the clock app do you typically use and why? 2. What features of the clock app do you know about but don't use? 3. If you want to set a reminder how do you go about it?
4. Can you rank the features of the iOS Clock App from most to least important?(World Clock, Alarms, Stopwatch, Timer)
5. Have you used the World Clock feature? If so, why?
6. Do you think this feature is useful and if so why?
7. If you need to check the time of a place in a different time zone what is the first place you go?
8. Do you have a system for organizing alarms and timers?

DIFFICULTIES:

1. Is there any part of this feature that is annoying or hard to use?
2. Is there anything missing in this feature you expected?

Alarms:

"Let's focus on the alarm feature now."

1. Have you used the Alarms feature? If so, for what?
2. How often do you snooze?
3. How many alarms do you usually set or have?
4. Do you have any repeating alarms you use on a consistent basis? If so, for what?
5. When your alarms change based on your daily schedule, do you set a new alarm each time or do you find a previous alarm you may have set for that time? (for ex. If you wake up at 6am every monday do you set a new alarm each time or look in your alarms list?)
6. Do you have any alternative Alarm apps that you use instead?

DIFFICULTIES:

1. Do you find it easy to edit, add or remove alarms?
2. Is there any part of setting and managing alarms that is annoying or hard to use?
3. Is there any part of the snooze functions that is annoying or hard to use? 4. Is there anything missing in this feature you expected?

Stopwatch:

"I'm going to ask a few questions about the stopwatch now."

1. Have you used the Stopwatch feature? If so, why?
2. Do you find this feature useful? If so, why?

DIFFICULTIES:

1. Is there any part of this feature that is annoying or hard to use?
2. Is there anything missing in this feature you expected?

Timer:

"**"Okay, moving to the timer feature now."**

1. Have you used the Timer feature? If so, why?

2. Do you ever get distracted when you set a timer and start scrolling on your phone instead? (i.e. instead of setting a timer you go to instagram or you set the timer and then go to safari, etc.)
3. Do you have any other apps you tend to use as a timer instead of the timer feature on ios? This includes apps you may be using to time your study sessions (pomodoro apps) or keep track of anything else similar? If so, for what?
4. Do you have any repeating timers that you're using on a daily basis (i.e you study daily with a timer)? If yes, how are you keeping track of which timer is for what?

DIFFICULTIES:

1. Do you have any difficulty in setting a timer?
2. How helpful do you think it would be to adjust a timer once you have already set it (extending or reducing time)?
3. Have there been any situations in which the ios timer did not fulfill the purpose you were using it for?
4. Is there anything missing in the timer that you would expect to be there? 5.

Do you experience any frustrations or inconveniences when using the timer?

<u>Tactful Communication:</u>

Redirecting:

1. That is a great point you just made. Can you elaborate more on how it directly relates to [insert question at matter]?

   OR
2. I see what you are saying here, and this is a lot of great information. If we have some time at the end, let's definitely return to this. For the time being though let's go back to [insert question].

Need to move on:

1. That's very interesting and I would love to return to it if we have time, but could we talk a little bit more about [Next Question].

Deflecting:

1. I see what you mean take your time to come up with a response but we are really interested in [restate goal of question] when talking about [restate question]
   OR
2. That's a great question, take your time to respond but we are really interested in [restate goal of question] when talking about [restate question].

Summary Questions:

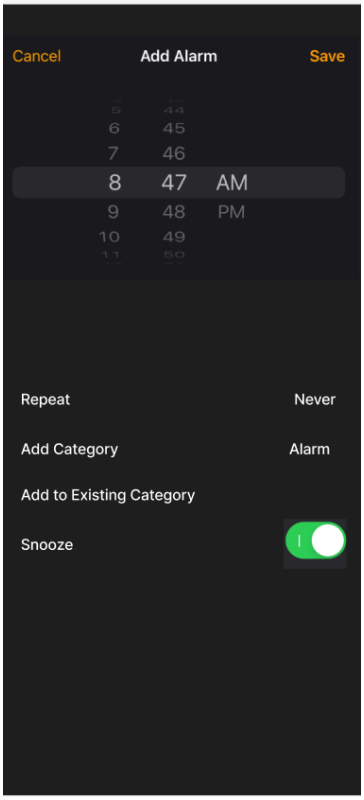
1. So just to recap, what would you say you like the most about the clock app?
2. Where would you say the clock app needs the most improvement? 3. Which feature is the most important to you?
4. You mentioned using the clock app for the following [insert what user has stated to use the clock for]. Is it fair to say that the most important functions you use the clock for are: [insert based on users previous responses]?

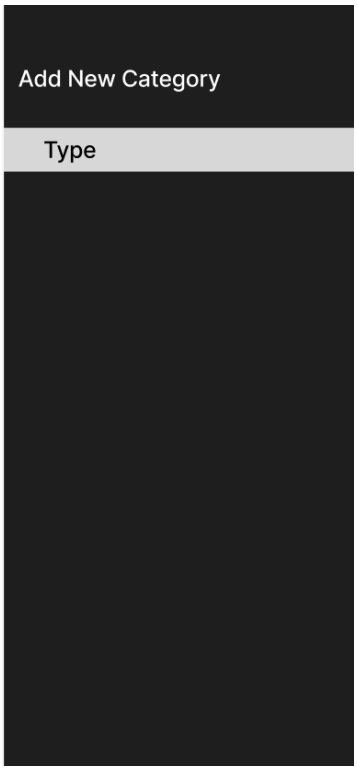
Finishing Up:

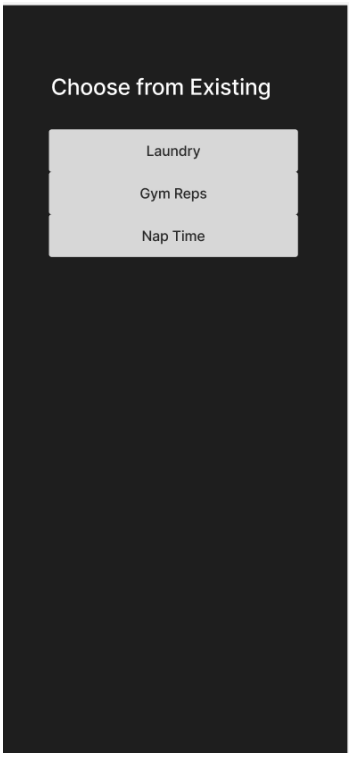
1. Inform the participants that they have answered all the questions.
2. Ask if there anything else they would like to add?
   a. “Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience with the app?”
3. Thank participants for their time.
4. End interview.

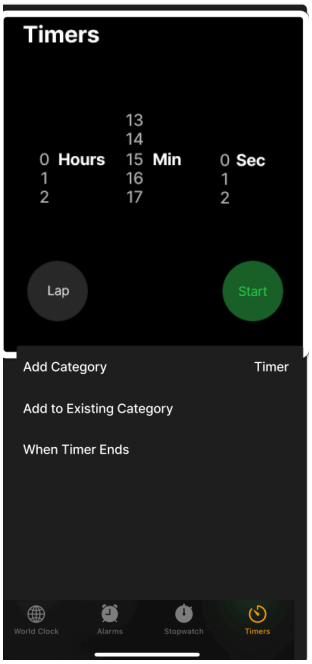
Prototype

Interactable prototype to add a new category to organize alarms and timers:
https://www.figma.com/proto/bAqnFlGECNZhy342XiZyBD/Prototype-ios?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=dLKI3pFa9Y6IJnhk-0&scaling=scale-down&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=0%3A1&starting-point-node-id=1%3A27&show-proto-sidebar=1


Cancel
Add Alarm
Save
6 45
7 46
8 47 AM
9 48 PM
10 49
Repeat
Never
Add Category
Alarm
Add to Existing Category
Snooze


Add New Category
Type


Choose from Existing
Laundry
Gym Reps
Nap Time


Timers
0 Hours
1
2
13
14
15 Min
16
17
0 Sec
1
2
Lap
Start
Add Category
Timer
Add to Existing Category
When Timer Ends
World Clock
Alarms
Stopwatch
Timers